AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2024

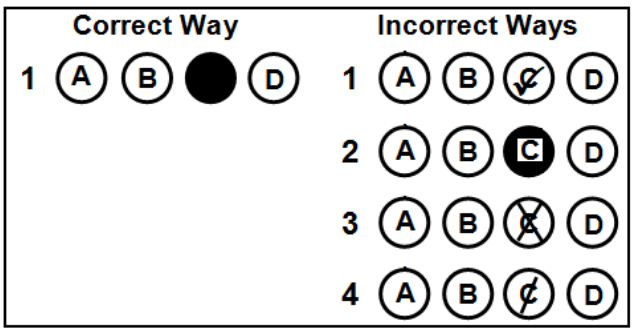
English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 55 minutes Marks: 40

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 40 only.
4. In each question, there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid, black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section, you will hear two passages. Each one will be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage and then read questions 1 to 10. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to record your answers.

Follow the instructions on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options, A, B, C or D, you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

The speaker talks about a sportsman.

Source: Adapted from '*Javelin thrower Arshad Nadeem creates history*' by Natasha Raheel

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The speaker begins the heard passage by

   A. defining the Olympic Games.
   B. describing javelin throwing.
   C. comparing two athletes.
   D. mentioning an athlete.

2. Consider the given sentence from the heard passage.

   'He threw the spear…in the first attempt, which was his personal best…'

   The underlined word is MAINLY used in the context of

   A. achievement.
   B. punctuality.
   C. adventure.
   D. behaviour.

3. Which of the following actions did Arshad perform to engage the crowds at the Birmingham Games?

   A. Applauding
   B. Mediating
   C. Chanting
   D. Jumping

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

4. The distance at which Arshad threw the spear in the third attempt was

   A. 85.09 m.
   B. 86.81 m.
   C. 88.0 m.
   D. 90.18 m.

5. What was the reason for Arshad not going for his elbow surgery?

   A. He began taking alternative medicines to heal his elbow.
   B. He was told not to go through with it.
   C. He wanted to participate in an event.
   D. He feared the surgery.

6. Based on the information by the speaker, the adjective that BEST describes Arshad is

   A. anxious.
   B. sarcastic.
   C. diplomatic.
   D. determined.

7. An alternative title for the heard passage could be

   A. '*Pakistan's Victory in Islamic Solidarity Games*'.
   B. '*History of the Commonwealth Games*'.
   C. '*The Boy Wonder from Pakistan*'.
   D. '*The Legacy of Tokyo Olympics*'.

8. The information in the passage is given through

   A. opinions.
   B. definitions.
   C. descriptions.
   D. speculations.

9. The speaker's MAIN purpose is to

   A. appreciate all international sporting competitions.
   B. suggest that all people should be sportspersons.
   C. develop an appreciation for Anderson Peters.
   D. trace the sporting journey of an athlete.

10. The text type of the heard passage is a/ an

    A. magazine article.
    B. autobiography.
    C. diary entry.
    D. interview.

Annual Exam 2024 EB
For Teaching & Learning only

Now, we will play the second passage. It will also be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first playing, and then read questions 11 to 20. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to record your answers.

Listening Passage II

In this passage, the speaker talks about mustard

Source: Adapted from '*What Are the Health Benefits of Mustard Seed?*' reviewed by Kathleen M. Zelman as published on https://www.webmd.com

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

11. The speaker begins the heard passage by

    A. stating the importance of the food industry.
    B. explaining the scientific name of mustard.
    C. mentioning the significance of mustard.
    D. listing various minerals.

12. All the following leafy-green vegetables are mentioned by the speaker EXCEPT

    A. kale.
    B. spinach.
    C. cabbage.
    D. broccoli.

13. The speaker mentions that mustard is served in small quantities.

    The reason behind this is because mustard has

    A. a pungent flavour.
    B. high sugar content.
    C. antioxidants.
    D. minerals.

14. Although eating mustard seeds is relatively safe, you should keep your intake in check.

    The underlined words, in the given sentence, from the heard passage are used to show

    I. concern
    II. sarcasm
    III. suggestion
    IV. uncertainty

    A. I and III.
    B. I and IV.
    C. II and III.
    D. II and IV.

15. The speaker mentions that erucic acid causes

    A. heart failure.
    B. skin allergies.
    C. liver problems.
    D. kidney damage.

16. The speaker states that as compared with yellow mustard seeds, brown seeds

    A. have a sweet taste.
    B. have no flavour.
    C. are more spicy.
    D. are toxic.

AKJ EB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

17. Which of the following aspects of mustard is NOT mentioned in the heard passage?

    A. Culinary (food) application
    B. Commercial cost
    C. Physical properties
    D. Chemical composition

18. The speaker provides information through

    A. scientific facts.
    B. statistical data.
    C. sequences.
    D. opinions.

19. The purpose of the speaker is to

    A. entertain.
    B. compare.
    C. inform.
    D. reflect.

20. The tone of the heard passage is

    A. monotonous.
    B. authoritative.
    C. enthusiastic.
    D. neutral.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

Reading Comprehension Section

You have 30 minutes' time for this section. This section has two reading passages; each followed by 10 multiple choice questions. You are advised to spend 15 minutes on each of the given passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Reading Passage I

We often think that our affairs, great or small, must be tended continuously and in detail, or our world will disintegrate and we will lose our places in the universe. That is not true, or if it is true, then our situations were so temporary that they would have collapsed anyway. Once a year or so I give myself a day away. On the eve of my day of absence, I begin to unwrap the bonds which hold me in harness. I inform housemates, my family and close friends that I will not be reachable for twenty-four hours; then I disengage the telephone. I turn the radio dial to an all-music station, preferably one which plays the soothing golden oldies. I sit for at least an hour in a very hot tub; then I lay out my clothes in preparation for my morning escape, and knowing that nothing will disturb me, I sleep the sleep of the just.

On the morning I wake naturally, for I will have set no clock, nor informed my body timepiece when it should alarm. I dress in comfortable shoes and casual clothes and leave my house going no place. If I am living in a city, I wander streets, window-shop, or gaze at buildings. I enter and leave public parks, libraries, the lobbies of skyscrapers, and movie houses.

On the getaway day I try for amnesia. I do not want to know my name, where I live, or how many dire responsibilities rest on my shoulders. I detest encountering even the closest friend, for then I am reminded of who I am, and the circumstances of my life, which I want to forget for a while.

Every person needs to take one day away. A day in which one consciously separates the past from the future. Jobs, family, employers, and friends can exist one day without any one of us, and if our egos permit us to confess, they could exist eternally in our absence.

Each person deserves a day away in which no problems are confronted, no solutions searched for. Each of us needs to withdraw from the cares which will not withdraw from us. We need hours of aimless wandering or spaces of time sitting on park benches, observing the mysterious world of ants and the canopy of treetops.

If we step away for a time, we are not, as many may think being irresponsible, but rather we are preparing ourselves to more ably perform our duties and discharge our obligations.

When I return home, I am always surprised to find some questions I sought to evade had been answered and some entanglements I had hoped to flee had become unraveled in my absence. A day away acts as a spring tonic. It can dispel rancor, transform indecision, and renew the spirit.

Source: Taken from '*A Day Away*' by Maya Angelou

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

21. "I begin to unwrap the bonds which held me in harness." The mentioned sentence (lines 4-5) relates closely and supports which of the following?

    A. I inform housemates, my family and close friends that I will not be reachable for twenty-four hours.
    B. I enter and leave public parks, libraries, the lobbies of skyscrapers, and movie houses.
    C. …our situations were so temporary that they would have collapsed anyway.
    D. A day in which one consciously separates the past from the future.

22. The word 'harness' in paragraph 1 means

    A. control.
    B. fatigue.
    C. escape.
    D. alarm.

23. The words 'casual', 'disengage' and 'gaze' (paragraphs 1 and 2) suggest a feeling of

    A. amazement.
    B. anticipation.
    C. relaxation.
    D. longevity.

24. Which of the following sentences could be added to the end of paragraph 2 to support the main idea?

    A. I stay in no place for very long.
    B. I would not want to visit too many places.
    C. I want to ignore everyone, including my mood.
    D. I think I cannot return to a place even if I want to.

25. The author says, 'a day away acts as a spring tonic' (line 29). By making this comparison, she means that

    A. we will have public approval if we take a day off.
    B. the break would increase chances of success.
    C. we should take our break in spring time.
    D. our break would revive and refresh us.

26. In the author's view, if we take one day off from our busy lives we

    A. should be labelled as irresponsible.
    B. would be energised to face the challenges.
    C. would search for solutions of our problems.
    D. should specially avoid meeting our relatives.

AKU-EB Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

27. The focus of the author on her ‘day away’ as described in the passage is

    A. to live without rules and responsibilities.
    B. not related to her family life.
    C. the world of ants and trees.
    D. to avoid her friends.

28. The author challenges those who are against her argument by saying

    A. if we step away for a time, we are not, as many may think being irresponsible, but rather we are preparing ourselves to more ably perform our duties.
    B. we need hours of aimless wandering or spaces of time sitting on park benches, observing the mysterious world of ants and the canopy of treetops.
    C. each person deserves a day away in which no problems are confronted, no solutions searched for.
    D. I do not want to know my name, where I live, or how many dire responsibilities rest on my shoulders.

29. Which of the given adjectives BEST describes the author’s personality?

    A. Irresponsible
    B. Hyperactive
    C. Reflective
    D. Lazy

30. The text type of the given passage is

    A. analytical.
    B. expressive.
    C. argumentative.
    D. communicative.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2024
for Teaching & Learning Only

Now read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Reading Passage II

The Great Resignation is an idea proposed by Professor Anthony Klotz of Texas A&M University that predicts many people leaving their jobs after the COVID pandemic ends and life returns to 'normal'. Managers are now navigating the ripple effects from the pandemic, as employees re-evaluate their careers and leave their jobs in record numbers.

At the onset of the pandemic, the job market was full of uncertainty and mass layoffs: millions of people lost their jobs, and those lucky enough to remain employed remained put in their roles for survival. However, as we now turn towards recovery, workers in privileged positions who don't live paycheck to paycheck are now finally moving on. Most [employees] in non-developed economies with the absence of social security and unemployment benefits cannot afford this luxury but may still be undergoing duress and pent-up frustration from the disruption caused by the pandemic.

These trends highlight the importance to understanding why people are leaving and what can be done to prevent 'The Great Resignation'. It also calls for a data-driven approach to determine not just how many people are quitting, but who exactly has the highest turnover risk…

The study of organisations is fascinating because many things we hold dear are the result and product of organisations and the leadership therein. When things don't work out, when services fail, or products lack a certain quality – it is all the result of organisational failure…

We have yet to see what a post pandemic world and workplace will look like. What we can already see is that how we organise work and work together will not return to the way it was before the pandemic. Many companies have announced that their employees never have to return to the office fulltime…I expect that companies will allow a part of their workforce to work fully remote most of the time and allow another part of their workforce to come to the office only on 1-2 days a week…This new way of organising work requires a different leadership style also demands new skills from workers. Self-leadership will gradually replace leadership through leaders and control…

During the pandemic, some of the most popular employers have announced that their workers never have to come back into the office regularly again, so it certainly will become an issue of employer attractiveness. There are many benefits of remote working, as employers can save on real estate costs and tap into global talent flexibly. The degree of remote work will also depend upon how well firms manage the challenges that come with remote work…Overall, virtual and remote work is mostly here to stay…

Source: Adapted from '*What is 'The Great Resignation'?*' as published on https://www.weforum.org

AKUEB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

31. In paragraph 2, the author mentions that the condition of workers in non-developed economies is

A. stable.
B. vague.
C. pitiful.
D. promising.

32. In paragraph 3, the author mentions data-driven approach in order to

A. describe the importance of resignations.
B. discuss his own approach towards work.
C. highlight Anthony Klotz's approach during research.
D. discuss its significance in exploring reasons for resignations.

33. It can be MAINLY inferred from paragraph 5 that employers will

I. demand that their employees return to work full time
II. allow their employees to work from home
III. raise the salaries of all employees

A. I only.
B. II only.
C. I and III.
D. II and III.

34. Consider the given features of a company:

- Open communication between senior management and staff
- Salaries of staff members are raised significantly each year
- Nursery facility available for all parents

Based on the information in the passage and the given features, the company's values can be identified as

A. rigid.
B. pluralistic.
C. traditional.
D. discriminatory.

35. The underlined word in line 27 is used in the context of

A. unit.
B. rank.
C. level.
D. certificate.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

36. All of the following words are used in the context of 'resignation' in the given passage EXCEPT

A. turnover.
B. quitting.
C. benefits.
D. failure.

37. The author's purpose is to

A. discuss reasons for people leaving their jobs.
B. persuade people to resign from their jobs.
C. mention strategies to work from home.
D. compare leadership styles.

38. The information in the passage is given through

A. sequences.
B. comparisons.
C. statistical data.
D. fact-based opinions.

39. Consider the given situation:

Person X, who is a 27-year-old female, has resigned from the designation of an associate due to unrealistic deadlines and lack of cooperation by the company.

With reference to the information in the passage and the given situation, which of the following strategies would you use as a manager to retain her in your own department?

A. Accept her resignation
B. Give her a flexible work schedule
C. Offer her a position in another department
D. Refuse the resignation and ask her to work overtime

40. The text type of the given passage is a

A. news report.
B. documentary.
C. memorandum.
D. magazine article.

AKU-EB Examinations 2024 for Teaching & Learning only

END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

AKU-EB
Annual Examinations 2024
for Teaching & Learning only